

Complete Pet Nutrition Guide

Sri Lanka Edition

Feeding your pets for optimal health in tropical climates

Essential Nutrients for Pets

Daily Nutritional Requirements

Nutrient	Importance	Local Sources
Protein	Muscle development and repair	Fish (salaya, hurulla), chicken, eggs, curd
Carbohydrates	Energy source	Rice, sweet potato, jackfruit
Fats	Skin/coat health, energy	Coconut oil, fish oil, chicken fat
Fiber	Digestive health	Pumpkin, gotukola, lentils
Calcium	Bone health	Milk, small fish with bones, eggshell powder

Safe & Unsafe Local Foods

Common Sri Lankan Foods

Food Item	Dogs	Cats	Notes
Coconut (pol, kurumba)	Safe	Safe	Excellent source of healthy fats
Jackfruit	Safe	Limited	Remove seeds, high in fiber
Mango	Safe	Safe	Remove pit, high sugar content
Onion/garlic	Toxic	Toxic	Causes anemia - avoid all forms
Chocolate	Toxic	Toxic	Especially dangerous in heat
Tea/Coffee	Toxic	Toxic	Caffeine is dangerous

Local Tip: Many Sri Lankan homes feed "rice and fish" - ensure bones are removed and avoid spicy curries. Coconut scrapings (pol kudu) make a healthy occasional treat.

Feeding Portions Guide

Small Dogs (1-10kg)

- Dry food:** 1/4 - 1 cup daily
- Homemade:** 1/2 cup rice + 1/4 cup protein
- Local option:** 1 kottu roti portion size

Medium Dogs (10-25kg)

- Dry food:** 1 - 2.5 cups daily
- Homemade:** 1 cup rice + 1/2 cup protein
- Local option:** 1 rice and curry takeaway portion

Cats (All sizes)

- Dry food:** 1/4 - 1/2 cup daily
- Wet food:** 1-2 small tins (or fresh fish)
- Local option:** 1-2 small fish (salaya) daily

Tropical Climate Feeding Tips

Hot Weather Adjustments

- Hydration:** Always provide 2x more water than food volume
- Feeding time:** Early morning/late evening when cooler
- Food storage:** Use airtight containers to prevent ants/weevils
- Natural coolers:** Add cucumber or watermelon (seedless) to meals

Local Solution: Clay water bowls stay cooler than plastic in Sri Lankan heat. Place in shaded areas and change water 3-4 times daily.

Homemade Food Recipes

Simple Sri Lankan Pet Meal

Ingredients:

- 1 cup cooked rice (red rice preferred)
- 1/2 cup boiled chicken/fish (bones removed)
- 2 tbsp grated coconut
- 1 tbsp curd
- 1/4 cup mashed pumpkin/gotukola

Preparation: Mix all ingredients and serve at room temperature. Store in refrigerator for max 2 days.

Hot Weather Hydration Boost

Ingredients:

- 1 cup coconut water (kurumba)
- 1/2 cup plain yoghurt
- 1 tbsp honey (for dogs only)
- Ice cubes (optional)

Mix and serve as occasional treat. **Avoid for cats.**

Commercial Food Guide for Sri Lanka

Brand	Available At	Price Range (Rs.)	Best For
Pedigree	Keells, Cargills, Laughs	800-2000	Adult dogs
Royal Canin	Veterinary clinics, Pet Mart	1500-5000	Special diets
Whiskas	Supermarkets islandwide	300-1200	Cats
ProPlan	Pet shops, online	2000-4000	Active dogs

Money-Saving Tip: Buy larger bags (10kg+) from wholesale markets like Pettah for better value. Store in airtight containers with bay leaves to prevent insects.